Pesto

Sauces & dips | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Makes about 1 cup. Pack basil leaves, freshly grate cheese, and mince garlic. Use a food processor.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 2 cups fresh basil leaves, packed
- [ ] 1/2 cup freshly grated Parmesan-Reggiano or Romano cheese
- [ ] 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- [ ] 1/3 cup pine nuts or walnuts
- [ ] 3 medium sized garlic cloves, minced
- [ ] Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste

1. Prepare and cook

1. 1 Combine the basil in with the pine nuts, pulse a few times in a food processor. (If you are using walnuts instead of pine nuts and they are not already chopped, pulse them a few times first, before adding the basil.) Add the garlic, pulse a few times more.

2. 2 Slowly add the olive oil in a constant stream while the food processor is on. Stop to scrape down the sides of the food processor with a rubber spatula. Add the grated cheese and pulse again until blended. Add a pinch of salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste.

3. Serve with pasta, or over baked potatoes, or spread over toasted baguette slices.

4. Yield: Makes 1 cup.

Notes

The file also suggests trying the linked Serious Eats recipe; the saved ingredient quantities and method are retained here.